

# Build a Windows File Explorer Inspired Document Manager

Create a modern web application called **DocVault**.

## Goal

Build a clean document management application inspired by **Windows File Explorer**. The application should focus on simplicity, speed, and organization rather than excessive animations or unnecessary UI elements.

The design should feel like a professional desktop application while remaining responsive for the web.

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## Tech Stack

Frontend:

- React
- TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS
- shadcn/ui
- React Router
- TanStack React Query

Backend (API only):

- Node.js
- Express
- MongoDB

Do not use Firebase.

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## Design Style

Theme:

- Windows 11 File Explorer
- Minimal
- Professional
- Clean

- Soft shadows
- Rounded corners (10–12px)
- Neutral colors
- Excellent spacing
- Modern typography
- No glassmorphism
- No neon colors
- No gradients except very subtle backgrounds

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## Application Layout



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## Header

Top navigation should include:

- Application Logo
  - "DocVault"
  - Search Bar
  - Upload Button
  - New Folder Button
  - User Avatar
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# Sidebar

Similar to Windows Explorer.

Items:

 Home

 Documents

 Favorites

 Trash

⚙ Settings

Selected item should have a subtle background highlight.

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# Main Content

Display folders and files.

Columns:

- Name
- Type
- Modified Date
- Size

Folders appear before files.

Each row should contain:

Folder:

 Projects

 HR

 Personal

Files:

 Resume.pdf

 Invoice.pdf

 Screenshot.png

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## Toolbar

Include:

New Folder

Upload Files

Refresh

Delete

Rename

Grid/List Toggle

Sort

More

Buttons should use shadcn components.

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## Breadcrumb

Example:

Home > Documents > Projects > UI Designs

Each breadcrumb should be clickable.

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## Context Menu

Right-click on any folder or file.

Show:

Open

Rename

Delete

Download

Properties

The menu should look similar to Windows.

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## Upload

Provide:

Upload Button

AND

Drag & Drop upload area

Show upload progress.

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## Empty State

If no files exist:

Large folder illustration

Text:

"No documents yet"

Button:

Upload your first file

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# File Cards

When Grid View is enabled:

Folders:

Large folder icon

Folder name

File count

Files:

File icon

File name

Size

Date

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# List View

Table layout.

Columns:

Name

Type

Modified

Size

Hover effect on rows.

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# Search

Search instantly while typing.

Highlight matching results.

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## Responsive Design

Desktop:

Sidebar always visible.

Tablet:

Collapsible sidebar.

Mobile:

Sidebar becomes a drawer.

Toolbar wraps correctly.

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## Colors

Background:

**F6F8FA**

Cards: White

Primary:

**2563EB**

Border:

**E5E7EB**

Text:

**111827**

Secondary Text:

**6B7280**

Success:

**22C55E**

Danger:

**EF4444**

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## Animations

Keep animations subtle.

Use smooth transitions for:

Hover

Folder opening

Context menu

Upload progress

Modal opening

Duration: 150–250ms

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## Components Needed

Header

Sidebar



Toolbar

Breadcrumb

File Table

File Grid

Folder Card

File Card

Upload Modal

Create Folder Dialog

Rename Dialog

Delete Confirmation

Context Menu

Search Input

Status Bar

Loading Skeleton

Empty State

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## UX Requirements

Double-click opens folders.

Single-click selects.

Multi-select using Ctrl/Cmd.

Keyboard navigation.

Delete key removes selected items.

F2 renames selected item.

Escape closes dialogs.

Right-click opens context menu.

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## Data Model

Folder:

- id
- name
- parentFolderId
- createdAt

File:

- id
  - name
  - folderId
  - size
  - type
  - uploadedAt
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## Visual Goal

The final application should resemble a lightweight Windows File Explorer with a modern web interface. It should prioritize clarity, usability, and polished interactions over flashy effects, making it feel like a real productivity application suitable for showcasing in a professional portfolio.